question that if unity is wrongly superimposed on successive similar moments, what is making the mistake if there is no permanent knowing subject?

Alaya-vijnana: early Buddhism rejects belief in the soul (***atman***) and analyses human lives into five constituents: matter, sensations, perceptions, habits and thoughts. Nevertheless, they accept the ***karma*** theory that motivated and intentional actions generate good and bad latent potencies that must be exhausted in future spheres of experience. In the absence of a soul, there has to be some other factor that serves as the vehicle of those potentialities. The ***Vijnanavada*** school postulated a 'storehouse consciousness' (***alaya-vijnana***) as the receptacle for these latent energies produced by morally significant actions. In addition, the contents of awareness, perceptions of an external world, memories and dreams are held to derive from a beginningless supply of residual traces of experience (***vasana***) in the form of latent mental states and dispositions of character preserved in this underlying subconscious level of mind. It also generates the illusion of a real, stable, individual subject confronting a world of objects. The *alaya-vijnana* consisting of a series of thoughts and *karmic* 'seeds' accounts for the continuity of individual personality through death and the transition between lives and in spells of unconsciousness.

A stream of experiences (which we misinterpret as a person's life) consists of a vast store of latent mental impressions (***vasana***) left by previous ideas that inevitably come to fruition. In the beginningless series of births, ideas and their impressions are mutually related as causes and effects, as plants spring from seeds and seeds from plants. The variety of ideas arises from the variety of impressions just as the variety of ideas in dreams arises from mental impressions in the absence of external objects.